

St. Margaret's Cemetery Annual Report TIRRA AGM March 22 2018

Please see the attached Treasure's report for a complete picture of the financial situation for St.Margarets Cemetery.

St.Margaret's overall financial situation for 2017 was as follows: the year began with \$34,606 in the bank. Excess of revenues over expenses equaled-\$4,073. Leaving us with \$30,533.

There were 3 interments of cremated remains in 2017 and no burials of full body remains.

The cemetery has had a very quiet year in terms of burials and the sale of plots but it has been very busy otherwise. Last fall work was begun on renovating the cemetery to accommodate the future opening of the new Green Burial area. The fence at the backside of the cemetery running from East to West was taken down. After consulting with Ian Ralston about our future designs for the cemetery it was decided that the ditch, which ran parallel to this fence, be remediated into an interception drain. By doing this we could take better advantage of space taken up by the ditch and put a path that would sit on top of the new drain system. Work began in October. The job was contracted out to Dave Knowles Excavating. The ditch was deepened to a narrow trench into which a Nilex Multiflow piping was placed. The drain was then covered with sand to the surface. Due to a miss communication the sand was then covered over with the material that had been dug out to prepare the trench. As the rainy season started to hit flooding into the cemetery occurred. It was made pretty clear that with the sand being covered and with sediment from up slope washing down, the interception drain could not work properly. Some of this soil material was quickly scrapped off by hand and some by Dave Knowles Excavating. A temporary swale was made which did prevent some flooding into the cemetery over the winter. Because of these events more work needs to be done in order to get this drain to function as it should. The work to begin later this spring is as follows: surface soil to be scrapped off to reveal the sand layer placed down earlier. More sand added to raise the height over which crushed gravel will be placed. A swale will be created on the forest side of the drain/path to capture the water and direct it to the drain. More on the path to come later in this report.

An existing ditch, which ran along side St.Margarets Lane on the east side and swung west, to connect to another drainage ditch was cleaned up. A culvert which had been place in this ditch years ago and on which the entrance for vehicles and maintenance was made was paid attention to. Although we had noticed it in the past it did not appear to have an exit point and therefor was not functioning at all. With the hard work of Glen Andison this ditch was deepened and the culvert placed back in such a way as to make it functional. This ditch now drains efficiently and now connects with the other ditch on the west side of the cemetery. The culvert came up a bit short in length however- a problem we will be addressing with highways. There is a temporary board covering the

gap. There are not enough words to express our thanks to Glen Andison for the hours he spent digging out these ditches and replacing the culvert as well as the numerous phone calls and consultation he gave us.

A large load of debris was hauled away by Thetis Island Property services at this time.

In January in the midst of the heavy rains that came this year a major slumping occurred on the bank. I have been doing a shoreline-monitoring program for the last few years trying to keep track of what has been happening. It had become increasingly clear that major erosion was taking place. This is a natural process that has been made more complex by the nature of the cemetery grounds and the way that water is moving through. A report by Hydrologist Alan Kohut commissioned by the cemetery Board confirmed this. Kohut also recommended some tree work be done in his report. I consulted with Keith Rush about the dangers with the trees on the bank and he agreed that something needed to be done soon. We came up with a plan. I spoke with Ian Shaw just before Christmas and had commissioned him to come and lighten the load on the fir trees and arbutus but sadly the weather broke down before he could get here to do that job. The portion of the bank, which slumped, had the roots of arbutus trees hanging on by a thread. It was not a total surprise but nevertheless it was upsetting. At present the area is barricaded off. The cemetery has been reopened but we ask the community to use caution.

This event has made the creation of a new pathway into the cemetery very necessary and to be done quickly. A new entrance from the Capernwray side will be made this spring thanks to the kindness of Capernwray, Ralf Kempe and Charlie Fordham. It will connect to the path on the drain system. There will also be a new entrance to the cemetery from St.Margarets Lane. Once all of this is done, the old gates will be removed and access will only occur along the new pathways. Some new fencing will take place in the next year.

There is some very exciting news to accompany these changes. St.Margaret's Cemetery has been chosen as a teaching site for a bioengineering workshop to be offered this fall by Nikki Wright and Sea Change. Dave Polster of Polster Environmental Services will facilitate the workshop. Dave is the guru of bank restoration. He will be helping us come up with a plan. There will be on site training. At this time we will also consult with Dave about re-naturalizing the old pathway. I have spoken with Dave about the current situation on the bank and he has recommended that we do nothing until this fall when the workshop takes place. This is a wonderful opportunity for us. We hope that the community will come out and support the work that needs to get done at that time. I want to thank the board members for their continued support and contribution towards the operation of the cemetery.

Many thanks to the volunteers who come forward to help with the spring cleanup and other projects. Special thanks to Keith rush. Continued thanks to Norm Kasting for lawn maintenance.

St.Margaret's Cemetery is managed by a Cemetery board in compliance with the Provincial Cremation, Interment and Funeral service Act now under consumer

Protection B.C. It operates as a sub committee under the auspices of TIRRA and is a registered charity.